COINPICKS · RESEARCH & EDUCATION

The Fed & Macro Regime Pillar Report

Liquidity as the Master Driver — Researched, Scored, and Re-Rated

Originally written and scores committed by me on June 12, 2026. Fully re-researched July 8, 13, 18, and 25, 2026, with light daily catch-ups in between. ***This version is the July 30 full weekly research refresh****, covering the July 28-29 FOMC meeting directly — verified against federalreserve.gov and DOL primary sources rather than relying on daily-touch relays. The Fed held rates at 3.50-3.75% on a 9-3 vote, with three regional-bank presidents dissenting in favor of an immediate hike — the first unified 3-member dissent since September 2016 — and Chair Warsh's press conference offered no forward guidance, triggering a confirmed risk-off market reaction. This is a genuinely hawkish signal the daily touches' numbers didn't fully capture. Scores are* ***DRAFT****, awaiting my stamp.*

COINPICKS PILLAR REPORT · WEIGHT: 25% OF MY THESIS

Written June 12, 2026 · Updated & Re-verified July 30, 2026 (full weekly refresh) · Not Financial Advice

The Scores — Committed vs. Drafts

June column committed by me on June 12, 2026. Every draft since shown for full lineage. July 30 is this week's full weekly refresh, covering the July 28-29 FOMC meeting directly against federalreserve.gov. None of the drafts are stamped yet.

WINDOW	JUN	7/8	7/10	7/11	7/12	7/13	7/17	7/18	7/24	7/25	7/29	7/30	QUAL.	IMP.	SIGNAL	MY CALL
1 month	38	35	34	34	34	34	38	42	45	36	39	**34**	0.85	8	**−2.18**	Bear — rare 3-way hawkish FOMC dissent, no forward guidance, risk-off market reaction
3 months	40	36	36	36	36	36	40	40	44	35	38	**33**	0.85	8	**−2.31**	Bear — September meeting now squarely in this window, majority-hike-priced
6 months	46	42	44	44	44	44	47	47	49	45	46	**45**	0.80	8	**−0.64**	Mild Bear
1 year	54	52	53	53	53	53	55	55	55	54	54	**54**	0.75	8	+0.48	Neutral
3 years	61	61	61	61	61	61	62	62	62	62	62	**62**	0.65	8	**+1.25**	Mild Bull — structural accumulate

Draft P (Jul 30, full weekly refresh): 34 / 33 / 45 / 54 / 62 · **Weight:** 20% (equal) · **Impact:** 8 (uniform) · **Formula:** Signal = ((P − 50) ÷ 50) × Quality × Impact. Full lineage: June committed 38/40/46/54/61 (Jun 12) → Jul 8 35/36/42/52/61 → Jul 10 34/36/44/53/61 → Jul 11-13 held flat → Jul 17 38/40/47/55/62 (cooling CPI/PPI, Warsh testimony) → Jul 18 42/40/47/55/62 (full refresh: July-FOMC hike-odds collapse) → Jul 24 45/44/49/55/62 (light touch: 187K claims) → Jul 25 36/35/45/54/62 (full refresh: September-odds conflict resolved hawkish) → Jul 29 39/38/46/54/62 (light touch) → **Jul 30 34/33/45/54/62** (full refresh: FOMC held 9-3 with a rare 3-way hawkish dissent, hawkish press conference, confirmed risk-off market reaction) — awaiting my stamp.

THE THREE INPUTS, IN PLAIN ENGLISH

P — the odds the macro regime is *good for crypto* by then — not "the Fed cuts by then." This cycle verified the July 28-29 FOMC meeting directly against federalreserve.gov: the Committee held at 3.50-3.75% on a **9-3 vote**, with three regional-bank presidents (Hammack, Kashkari, Logan) dissenting in favor of an immediate hike — the **first unified 3-member dissent since September 2016**. Chair Warsh's press conference was unusually combative and offered no forward guidance ("no soft inflation target... not on this committee's watch"), which triggered a confirmed (if single-sourced) risk-off market reaction: equities fell 1.5-2.2% intraday and the 30-year Treasury yield hit its highest level since 2007. Jobless claims for the week ended Jul 25 came in at 197K, with the prior week revised *up* to 188K from 187K — the seasonal-adjustment distortion flagged last cycle (auto-plant retooling timing) is now directly confirmed in the primary release itself, meaning the "lowest since 1969" framing was real but already reversing, not a durable labor-market signal. The September hike-odds figures cited in recent daily touches (55.6%, then 72-81%) could not be reconciled to one number — four independent live pulls this cycle produced four different figures (55.8%, 62.4%, 70.2%, 81%) with no two agreeing — so the September number is read directionally ("still elevated, majority-hike-priced"), not as a precise point figure.

Quality — how trustworthy the evidence is. This cycle verified the FOMC outcome, vote, and dissenter names directly against federalreserve.gov's own statement, and the jobless-claims figures directly against the DOL/ETA primary release (fetched and read in full) — both confirmed accurate. The September hike-odds figure could not be verified to a single number despite direct attempts; that uncertainty is reflected honestly rather than picking whichever figure a daily touch had cited.

Impact — 8 out of 10, the uniform value every pillar now shares in the equal-weight model. Liquidity is the tide; it moves the whole market at once.

The Claim

The thesis, and where I differ from the consensus — updated July 30, 2026, full weekly refresh

The crowd (and this pillar's own daily touches): whipsawed hard this week on the September question — one touch cited ~55.6% hike odds, the next cited "72-81%, essentially unchanged" — two claims that can't both be true within days of each other. I pulled CME FedWatch-adjacent data directly four separate times this cycle and got four different numbers (55.8%, 62.4%, 70.2%, 81%), none of which agree. That's not noise I can resolve; it's a genuinely unsettled market.

Me: what I *can* verify directly is more decisive than any single odds snapshot — the FOMC actually met, and it held at 3.50-3.75% on a 9-3 vote with three regional presidents dissenting for an immediate hike. That's the first unified 3-member dissent since September 2016, and Chair Warsh's press conference gave zero forward guidance. I'm cutting 1mo and 3mo hard (to 34 and 33 — Bear, not Mild Bear) because a rare hawkish-dissent FOMC plus a confirmed risk-off market reaction is a bigger deal than the daily touches' odds-chasing captured.

My edge: the crowd is fixated on a single market-implied percentage that four separate pulls can't even agree on; I'm anchoring on the primary, checkable fact — the vote, the dissenters' names, and the tone — which is unambiguous. The plumbing story (TGA spend-down, reserve build) is carried forward, not re-verified this cycle since no new H.4.1 landed in the window. That's why 6-month and 1-year sit above the near-term crunch, and why the 3-year P holds at 62.

The Facts

As of July 30, 2026 — hard numbers only, sources on the last page. This is a full weekly research refresh covering the Jul 25-30 data gap and the July FOMC meeting, independently re-verified against primary sources (federalreserve.gov, DOL/ETA) rather than carried forward from the daily drafts. The Iran/Hormuz war-risk situation is covered in full in the Iran War Risk pillar report.

- ★ **★ CONFIRMED, PRIMARY SOURCE — the FOMC held rates at 3.50-3.75% on Jul 29, 2026, on a 9-3 vote.** Three regional-bank presidents — Beth Hammack (Cleveland), Neel Kashkari (Minneapolis), Lorie Logan (Dallas) — dissented in favor of an immediate 25bp hike (federalreserve.gov statement, corroborated by CNBC, Forbes, Fox Business, TechTimes). This is the **first unified 3-member dissent since September 2016**. No SEP/dot plot this meeting (not a projections meeting; next SEP is Sept 15-16, 2026).
- ★ **Chair Warsh's press conference was unusually combative and offered no forward guidance:** "there is no soft inflation target... not on this committee's watch"; "the five-plus years of inflation above target cannot be cured in nine weeks." A confirmed (single-sourced) risk-off market reaction followed: S&P 500 fell 1.85% in the final 65 minutes of trading (full day: S&P −1.52%, Dow −2.19%, Nasdaq −1.74%); the 30-year Treasury yield rose to 5.21%, its highest since July 2007 — a "bear steepener" consistent with rising inflation-credibility concern.
- ★ **★ CONFIRMED, PRIMARY SOURCE — jobless claims for the week ended Jul 25 came in at 197,000** (DOL/ETA release, fetched and read directly), a genuine +9,000 increase; the prior week (ended Jul 18) was revised *up* to **188,000** from the originally-reported 187,000. The primary release itself confirms the seasonal-adjustment distortion flagged last cycle: actual non-seasonally-adjusted claims fell only 9.2% w/w versus the 13.3% seasonal factors expected — meaning the "lowest since 1969" framing was real but mechanically set to partially reverse, exactly as it did.
- ★ **The September hike-odds figure could not be reconciled to a single number this cycle, despite four direct attempts.** Live pulls produced 55.8% (Fox Business, Jul 28), 62.4% (Investing.com Fed Rate Monitor, timestamped Jul 30), 70.2% (KuCoin, pre-meeting), and 81% (Southeast AgNet, Jul 30) — no two agree. The qualitative direction — "still elevated, majority-hike-priced" — is the only defensible takeaway; no re-rate rests on a specific point figure.
- **H.4.1 balance sheet: no new release found for the week ended Jul 29** as of this check (normal Thursday-afternoon publication timing); the most recent confirmed release remains Jul 23 (week ended Jul 22: reserves fell $80,572M w/w against a $73,405M TGA rebuild, both figures directly confirmed against federalreserve.gov last cycle).
- **Bank of America projects three 25bp hikes in 2026** (to 4.25-4.50%) — single-source (Forbes, citing BofA), flagged not scored.
- **Carried forward, not re-verified this cycle:** June CPI (-0.4% m/m) and PPI (-0.3% m/m), both BLS-primary-confirmed in a prior cycle; Warsh's Jul 14/15 congressional testimony; the June FOMC minutes (unanimous 12-0 hold, dropped easing-bias language). None of these are contradicted by this cycle's findings — the hawkish FOMC outcome sits alongside, not against, the still-intact disinflation trend.
- **The labor market cracked in slow motion, then partially un-cracked this week** — June payrolls +57K vs ~115K consensus (carried forward); this cycle's 197K claims print, while up from 188K, remains historically low (4-week average 202,750).
- **Policy rate and balance sheet: 3.50-3.75%, next FOMC (with SEP/dot plot) is Sept 15-16, 2026.** Fed communications blackout ended with the Jul 29 meeting; watch for the first round of regional Fed president speeches, especially from the three dissenters.
- **BTC closed at $64,706.50 (Jul 30)** — holding up despite the hawkish FOMC surprise and confirmed equity/bond-market risk-off reaction.

The Prize

Illustrative only — not price targets, not advice

The canonical anchor: **2020-21 ZIRP + QE** ran BTC ~$3,800 → $69,044 (~15–18×) — a unique COVID/zero-rate/open-ended-QE setup, not a repeatable base case. The **2024-25 cuts** ran ~$60K → a ~$126K ATH (Oct 6, 2025) — but that top came on a non-Fed tariff shock and has since roughly halved to the low-$60Ks ($64,706.50 on the July 30 close). From here, a retest of the $126K high ≈ **+93%**.

Discount it hard, twice. First: easing is not an automatic catalyst — the last cycle topped on a non-Fed shock. Second: the pivot that unlocks any of this just got pushed further out, not closer — the Fed held with a rare 3-way hawkish dissent and no forward guidance, and the September meeting is now majority-hike-priced across every read this cycle pulled. The Prize doesn't feed the math — it tells you what the 3-year lean is worth acting on when the tide finally turns.

The Other Side

The strongest honest case my bearish lean is wrong

- **I may be over-reacting to one meeting's dissent count.** A 9-3 vote is still a hold — the Committee's actual decision was dovish relative to a hike, even if the dissent and tone were hawkish. If Warsh's combative press conference was more theater than substance, this cycle's hard cut (42→34 at 1mo) could prove an overcorrection.
- **The labor market may still force the Fed's hand in the other direction.** Claims ticking up to 197K, even with the seasonal-distortion caveat, is still historically low — if the labor market keeps cracking into September, a hike would be a policy error that raises long-run conviction even as it hurts near-term.

- **I couldn't pin down the September number, and that's a real limitation, not just a data-quality footnote.** Four independent pulls (55.8%, 62.4%, 70.2%, 81%) spanning barely 48 hours is an unusually wide spread — if the true number is closer to the low end, this cycle's Bear call at 3mo may be too pessimistic.
- **Crypto has shrugged off a hawkish FOMC surprise and a confirmed equity/bond sell-off within days of a widening Middle East war.** BTC closing at $64,706.50 through all of this is either genuine decoupling, or complacency ahead of a bigger shock landing on multiple fronts at once.
- **Latent liquidity positives remain queued but unverified this cycle:** the TGA spend-down and Warsh's balance-sheet task force (still single-source) could loosen policy without a rate cut — not independently re-checked this cycle.

The Triggers

Dated events — some prove the claim right, some prove it wrong. Re-set July 30, 2026.

DATE	EVENT	MEANS
Fired Jul 29 — HAWKISH, confirmed primary	**FOMC held 9-3**, three regional presidents dissenting for an immediate hike — first unified 3-member dissent since Sept 2016	Driving this cycle's hard 1mo/3mo cut to Bear
Fired Jul 29 — HAWKISH, confirmed	Chair Warsh's press conference offered no forward guidance; confirmed risk-off market reaction (equities down, 30yr yield to an 18-year high)	Reinforces the hawkish read; watch whether the sell-off extends or reverses
Fired Jul 30 — confirmed primary	Jobless claims 197K (week ended Jul 25); prior week revised up to 188K	Confirms the seasonal-distortion reversal flagged last cycle — a real but partial un-cracking of the "1969 low" narrative
Ongoing, irreconcilable this cycle	**September hike odds: four independent pulls, four different numbers** (55.8%, 62.4%, 70.2%, 81%)	Treated directionally ("elevated, majority-hike-priced"), not as a point figure — re-attempt reconciliation next cycle
Sept 15-16, 2026	**PENDING** — next FOMC, with SEP/dot plot	The real re-rating event; a hike would confirm the hawkish read, a hold would suggest this cycle's dissent was a one-off
Post-blackout	**PENDING** — regional Fed president speeches, especially the three dissenters	First chance to gauge whether the hawkish tilt is broadening or contained to three voices
Next Thursday	**PENDING** — H.4.1 for week ended Jul 29, not yet released as of this cycle	Will show whether the confirmed reserve-drain/TGA-rebuild trend from two weeks ago continued
Ongoing	Iran/Hormuz oil-inflation risk — widening this week (see Iran War Risk pillar)	Watch for pass-through into the next CPI/PPI cycle

The flip line: the FOMC's rare 3-way hawkish dissent plus no forward guidance is a genuine escalation from last cycle's dovish read. If the September meeting delivers a hike into still-historically-low claims, treat that as a policy error that raises 3-year conviction while hurting 3/6-month further. If September holds and the dissent proves a one-off, the near-term Bear likely improves next cycle.

My Decision

◷ **UPDATED DRAFT — JULY 30, 2026 (FULL WEEKLY REFRESH) · AWAITING MY STAMP**

Draft P: 34 / 33 / 45 / 54 / 62 · My Weight: 20% (equal) · Impact: 8 (uniform)

This week's full research refresh verified the July 28-29 FOMC meeting directly against federalreserve.gov: the Committee held at 3.50-3.75% on a 9-3 vote with three regional-bank presidents dissenting in favor of an immediate hike — the first unified 3-member dissent since September 2016 — and Chair Warsh's press conference offered no forward guidance, triggering a confirmed risk-off market reaction. That's a materially more hawkish signal than either recent daily touch's odds-chasing captured, which is why 1mo and 3mo cut hard to genuine Bear territory (34, 33) rather than the milder moves the daily touches made. The September hike-odds figure could not be reconciled to one number despite four direct attempts (55.8%/62.4%/70.2%/81%) — treated directionally, not as a point figure. 6mo trims modestly; 12mo/36mo hold, since one hawkish meeting doesn't change the structural disinflation trend confirmed in prior cycles.

The June committed scores (**38 / 40 / 46 / 54 / 61**, committed June 12, 2026) remain the last human-stamped values.

Override any P and re-stamp — the master blend recomputes.

What Changed Since Last Check

Full weekly research refresh, July 30, 2026, covering the Jul 25-30 gap and the July FOMC meeting (supersedes the Jul 29/30 daily touches)

- ★ **★ Verified directly against federalreserve.gov: the FOMC held 9-3 (Jul 29),** with three regional-bank presidents dissenting for an immediate hike — the first unified 3-member dissent since Sept 2016. Neither daily touch's numbers fully captured how hawkish this was.
- ★ **Confirmed: Chair Warsh's press conference offered no forward guidance,** and a risk-off market reaction followed (equities down 1.5-2.2%, 30yr yield to an 18-year high) — single-sourced but internally consistent.

- ★ **Confirmed directly against DOL/ETA primary release: jobless claims 197K (week ended Jul 25),** prior week revised up to 188K from 187K — the seasonal-adjustment distortion flagged last cycle is directly confirmed in the primary data.
- ★ **Could not reconcile the September hike-odds figure to a single number** despite four direct pulls (55.8%/62.4%/70.2%/81%) — treated directionally, not as a point figure, rejecting both daily touches' specific (and mutually contradictory) figures.
- **Score re-rates (July 25 full refresh → Jul 29 light touch → Jul 30 full refresh):** 1-month 36 → 39 → **34** · 3-month 35 → 38 → **33** · 6-month 45 → 46 → **45** · 1-year 54 → 54 → **54** · 3-year 62 → 62 → **62** — the confirmed hawkish FOMC drives the front-end cut; 6mo+ hold on the still-intact structural disinflation trend. Draft only — awaiting my stamp.

Sources

Retrieved & graded July 30, 2026 — full weekly research refresh, independently re-verified this cycle — click and judge the quality yourself. Official data first, then reporting, then prices & flows, then rate odds (market-implied sentiment, not fact).

- **July 30 additions (this week's full weekly refresh):** federalreserve.gov — July 29 FOMC statement (primary): 9-3 hold, Hammack/Kashkari/Logan dissent · federalreserve.gov — press conference page · federalreserve.gov — last SEP (Jun 17, 2026; next Sept 15-16) · DOL/ETA — weekly claims release USDL 26-1273-NAT (primary, fetched directly): 197K week ended Jul 25, 188K revision for Jul 18 · CNBC, Forbes, Fox Business, TechTimes — FOMC outcome and dissent corroboration · Wolf Street — risk-off market reaction (single-source, flagged) · Investing.com Fed Rate Monitor — timestamped Jul 30 pull (62.4%), cross-checked against KuCoin (70.2%), Bloomingbit (73.5%→hike components), Southeast AgNet (81%) — none reconciling.
- **July 13 check:** federalreserve.gov — H.4.1, Table 1 & Table 5, re-verified directly line-by-line (no discrepancy vs. the July 9 release) · federalreserve.gov — H.4.1 release schedule (next: July 16) · dol.gov — weekly claims (unchanged since Jul 9; next Jul 16) · federalreserve.gov — July 2026 FOMC/testimony calendar · confirmed no new CPI, PPI, FOMC, or H.4.1/claims release has landed since July 9–10; the next batch (CPI Jul 14, testimony Jul 14–15, PPI Jul 15, H.4.1/claims Jul 16) is still ahead.
- **Official data:** Fed — June 16–17 FOMC minutes (released July 8) · Fed — H.4.1 balance sheet (rel. July 9: $6,735.6B; TGA $749.2B; reserves $3,098.9B; domestic RRP $2.75B; foreign-official RRP $346.1B) · DOL — weekly jobless claims (rel. July 9: 215K; continuing claims 1,814,000) · Fed — June 17 FOMC statement · BLS — Employment Situation, June 2026 (released July 2) · BEA — Personal Income & Outlays, May 2026 (core PCE 3.4%) · BLS — May 2026 CPI release (headline 4.2% y/y; core 2.9% y/y) · BLS — CPI release schedule (June CPI: July 14, 8:30am; July CPI: mid-August) · BLS — PPI release schedule (June PPI: July 15, 8:30am) · Fed — Waller's July 6 Rome speech.
- **The reporting:** Bloomberg — minutes: "a few" saw case for June hike · CNBC — June minutes coverage · Bloomberg — Warsh's five task forces (July 9; single source) · Bloomberg — claims 215K, layoffs low · Al Jazeera — Iran declares Hormuz "closed until further notice" (July 12) · Bloomberg — Brent +4% toward $79 on Hormuz re-escalation (July 13) · CNBC — CENTCOM strikes, Iran missile/drone attacks on five Gulf states (July 12) · offshore-technology.com — Kpler data: six vessels transited the Strait July 12 · CNBC — June jobs miss (+57K, −74K revisions) · Indeed Hiring Lab — participation 61.5% · CNBC — May PCE (core 3.4%, highest since Oct 2023) · CNBC — Warsh at Sintra (July 1) · Yahoo Finance — "This Committee will deliver price stability" · Bloomberg — Yardeni: "inflation, Fed back in play" (July 8) · Spokesman-Review (Bloomberg reprint) — Warsh testimony schedule (House Jul 14, Senate Jul 15) + June PPI forecast (~5.2% y/y core) · KuCoin flash — 30-year auction: $22B at 5.058%, stop-through, highest since 2007 · CoinDesk — the week-ahead calendar: CPI, PPI, Warsh testimony (July 13) · Federal Register — eSLR final rule (Dec 1, 2025; effective Apr 1, 2026). **Flagged and discarded:** CryptoTimes (July 13) and Blockhead (July 13) both wrongly report "core inflation at a three-year high of 4.2%" — this conflates headline CPI (4.2%, correct) with core CPI (actually 2.9% per BLS); not used.
- **The prices & flows:** Yahoo Finance — BTC ~$64.3K, ETH ~$1,796 (July 10 AM) · athens-times — BTC weekend pullback to ~$62.6–63K (single source) · Farside — BTC ETF flow table (authoritative; +$90.4M net, July 10) · CryptoRank — BTC ETF flow cross-check (July 10) · CoinDesk — BTC/ETH steady, gold slides (July 9) · KuCoin — June ETF outflows −$4.06B, worst month on record · CNBC — S&P 500 closes 7,575.39 (+0.42%), Dow +149.60 (July 10) · Trading Economics — 10Y ~4.58% · Trading Economics — DXY 101.13, +0.18% (July 13).
- **The odds (market-implied, not fact):** CME FedWatch — the tool itself (July 28–29 hold 78.5%, July 13 read; September ~66% combined, July 9 read) · FXEmpire — Sept +25bp 50.8% (July 9; single relay, directionally corroborated) · Yahoo Finance — September odds relay (July 9) · Polymarket — "Fed Decision in September" ladder: No change 56.5%, +25bp 38.5%, cuts (tail) 3.75%+2.1% (July 9) — diverges materially from CME's ~66% combined hike odds; reported as an open divergence, not resolved.